

SOC Role in the Blue Team

A complete, beginner-friendly guide to the SOC, the Blue Team, security roles and a SOC career path - with every answer.

Learning Path: SOC Level 1 - Blue Team Introduction

Difficulty: Easy | Topics: Security hierarchy, SOC, CIRT, GRC, MSSP, career progression

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About this walkthrough

This document walks through every task of the TryHackMe room **SOC Role in Blue Team**. It explains how a security team is structured inside a company, who the Blue Team are and what each role does, how a SOC career progresses, and how to solve the final challenge.

What you will learn

- Where cyber security sits in a company and what a CISO does.
- The difference between the Red Team, Blue Team and GRC Team.
- The roles inside a SOC, the CIRT and specialised defensive teams.
- How to advance from a SOC L1 analyst, and the SOC L1 to L2 path.

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Before you start

This is a **theory** room, so there is no machine to deploy - only the final drag-and-drop challenge, which opens in your browser through the **View Site** button. The room builds on the **Junior Security Analyst Intro** room. Try each question yourself before checking the answer below. All answers are shown for educational purposes.

TASK 1

Introduction

The **Junior Security Analyst Intro** room introduced the SOC L1 analyst role. This room widens the view: where does that role sit in a company's structure, who oversees the team, which other security departments exist, and what skills do you need to climb the career ladder?

The learning objectives for the room are:

- Understand the concept and purpose of the Blue Team.
- Explore where the SOC sits within the company structure.
- Find out about your career path as a SOC L1 analyst.

Q1. Let's find out!

ANSWER

No answer needed - just start reading

TASK 2

Security Hierarchy

Every company's cyber security priorities are different, and the team structure follows those priorities. A law firm cares most about the privacy of legal documents, a factory cares about keeping production lines running, and a hospital cares above all about patient safety.

In a large organisation, the technical staff (such as SOC analysts) report to a department manager, who reports to the **CISO (Chief Information Security Officer)**. The CISO reports to the CEO. The CEO focuses on overall business strategy rather than technical detail, which is exactly why the security decision-making is delegated to the CISO.

Team	Focus	Typical roles
Red Team	Offensive security	Penetration testers, ethical hackers
Blue Team	Defensive security	SOC analysts, incident responders, engineers
GRC Team	Governance, risk and compliance	Policy and regulation specialists

Smaller companies often cannot justify all three teams and may run a single generic IT or "Information Security" team instead. This room focuses on the larger structure, where a CISO oversees several specialised teams.

Q1. Which senior role typically makes key cyber security decisions?

ANSWER

CISO (Chief Information Security Officer)

Q2. What is the common name for roles like SOC analysts and engineers?

ANSWER

Blue Team

TASK 3

Meet the Blue Team

The **Blue Team** is the defensive side of security: it continuously monitors for attacks and responds to them quickly. Depending on the size and sector of the company a Blue Team can range from about **3 to 50** members, and it is usually made up of several departments and roles.

The Security Operations Centre (SOC)

The SOC is the first line of defence and the most likely place to start your career. It handles alerts, investigates incidents and configures the detection tools. Its common roles are:

- **L1 Analysts** - triage alerts and escalate complex cases.
- **L2 Analysts** - investigate more advanced threats.
- **Engineers** - manage and configure tools such as EDR and SIEM.
- **Manager** - oversees the whole SOC operation.

The Cyber Incident Response Team (CIRT)

When SOC expertise is not enough, or an incident spirals out of control, the **CIRT** (also called CSIRT or CERT) is called in urgently. Its members have broad threat knowledge and can handle breaches without depending on tools like EDR or SIEM. Roles here include forensics experts, threat hunters, malware analysts and threat intelligence specialists. Real examples include **JPCERT** (Japan), **Mandiant** and **AWS CIRT**.

Specialised defensive roles

Large or technology-focused organisations may also employ narrower, deeper roles:

- **Digital Forensics Analyst** - hunts for hidden threats in disk and memory.
- **Threat Intelligence Analyst** - gathers data on emerging threat groups.
- **AppSec Engineer** - keeps the software development lifecycle secure.
- **AI Researcher** - studies AI-related security risks and defences.

Q1. Does Blue Team focus on defensive or offensive security?

ANSWER

Defensive

Q2. Which department handles active or urgent cyber incidents?

ANSWER

CIRT (Cyber Incident Response Team)

TASK 4

Advancing SOC Career

Starting as a **SOC L1 analyst** is a great entry point into cyber security. You handle real threats, gain hands-on experience and build foundational skills. It is engaging and educational even at the junior level.

A practical way to begin your SOC career:

- Learn core SOC skills such as SIEM and incident response, and practise them in CTFs.
- Stay current with cyber news and consider a certification such as SAL1.
- Prepare for interviews and understand the difference between an internal SOC and an MSSP.
- Apply for jobs, gain experience, and then aim for senior roles.

Not every organisation can run its own SOC. Many rely on a **Managed Security Services Provider (MSSP)** - a company that delivers outsourced security services, most commonly SOC services, to its clients. Working at an MSSP is often fast-paced with a high alert volume, but it exposes you to many different attacks and tools.

Aspect	Internal SOC	MSSP
Example	Protecting a bank's own systems	Protecting many clients across regions
Work pace	Generally calmer shifts	Fast-paced, high alert volume
Tools	Fewer tools, deep expertise	Many tools, broad exposure
Incidents	Limited major attacks per year	Frequent, diverse incidents

The natural next step after L1 is **SOC L2 analyst**. Other paths include engineering (if you enjoy building systems), the CIRT, and management - with the CISO role at the top of that ladder. Your first one to two years should focus on gaining real-world experience and discovering which area excites you most.

Q1. How would you call a cyber security company providing SOC services?

ANSWER

MSSP (Managed Security Services Provider)

Q2. Which role naturally continues your SOC L1 analyst journey?

ANSWER

SOC L2 analyst

TASK 5

Final Challenge

In this task you play the CISO of **TrySecureMe**, a large multinational company. Seven incidents happen at once and you must choose the right person for each one. Click **View Site**, then drag each role from the left onto the matching incident on the right. If all your choices are correct, the site reveals the flag. You can restart at any time with the **Reset** button.

Incident	Correct role
SIEM alert about a FW-NY-01 firewall brute-force - who triages it?	SOC L1 Analyst
HR manager Anna launched phishing malware - who does the deep analysis?	SOC L2 Analyst
The France office was hit by ransomware - immediate response required	CERT Lead
Credit-card servers need a PCI DSS audit	GRC Auditor
Who checks the new tryhackme.thm site for vulnerabilities?	Penetration Tester
SIEM is unavailable due to a storage limit - who investigates?	SOC Engineer
FIN7 threat group actively targets the company - who analyses their tactics?	Threat Researcher

Why each role fits

An L1 analyst triages fresh alerts; a deeper phishing investigation is L2 work; a ransomware outbreak needs the incident-response lead; PCI DSS is a governance and compliance (GRC) audit; checking your own site for bugs is penetration testing; a broken SIEM is an infrastructure problem for an engineer; and profiling a named threat group is the job of a threat researcher.

Q1. What flag did you claim after completing the final challenge?

ANSWER

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THM{trysecureme_is_secured!}
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TASK 6

Conclusion

That completes the room. You should now understand how a SOC team works, where it sits inside the security structure of a company, which roles make up the Blue Team and its supporting departments, and what the first steps of a SOC career look like. The next rooms in the path, **Humans as Attack Vectors** and **Systems as Attack Vectors**, look at what a SOC actually protects.

Q1. Complete the room!

ANSWER

No answer needed - just finish the room

Answer key at a glance

Every question in the room, in one place. Try to answer each task yourself first, then use this table to check your answers.

Task	Question	Answer
1	Introduction	No answer needed
2	Senior role that makes key cyber security decisions	CISO
2	Common name for SOC analysts and engineers	Blue Team
3	Does the Blue Team focus on defensive or offensive security?	Defensive
3	Department handling active or urgent cyber incidents	CIRT
4	Company providing SOC services	MSSP
4	Role that continues your SOC L1 journey	SOC L2 analyst
5	Flag from the final challenge	THM{trysecureme_is_secured!}
6	Complete the room	No answer needed

Next steps

Continue to **Humans as Attack Vectors** and **Systems as Attack Vectors** to see the threats your SOC defends against, and revisit the **Junior Security Analyst Intro** room whenever you want to refresh the day-to-day of an L1 analyst.